INTERNATIONAL news

Nvidia launches 3 new chips for China amid US restrictions

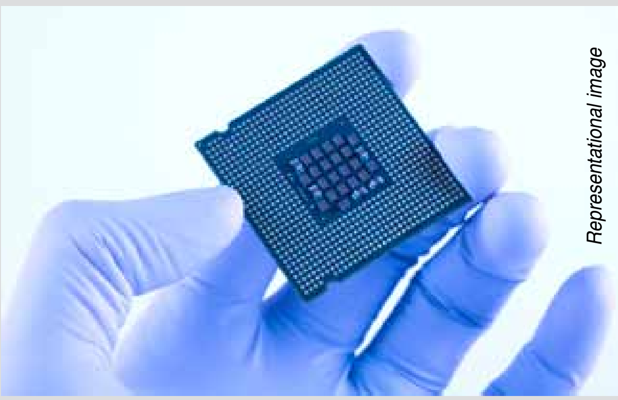
Nvidia is adapting to recent US export controls by launching three new AI chips tailored for the Chinese market, potentially mitigating the impact on sales caused by restrictions on high-end AI chip sales to China. US export controls imposed last month affected Nvidia's sales of two AI chips (A800 and H800) designed for China. The new chips retain Nvidia's advanced AI features but with reduced computational abilities to comply with the latest US regulations. The regulations limit computational capacity within a certain physical size and introduce a 'grey zone' requiring a license for export.

LG Energy to supply 20GWh of EV batteries to Toyota

LG Energy Solution has signed a long-term contract with Toyota to supply 20GWh of electric vehicle batteries annually. The South Korean battery manufacturer will invest 4 trillion won until 2025 to establish a dedicated battery cell and modular line in its Michigan plant to meet Toyota's battery supply needs. LG Energy Solution will supply battery modules that consist of NCMA-based pouch cells, which will be assembled as packs at Toyota's plant in Kentucky. This contract with Toyota means that LG Energy Solution now counts all five major car brands in the US, including Honda, General Motors, Hyundai Motor, and Stellantis, as customers for electric vehicle batteries.

Microsoft launches proprietary AI chips focused on cost efficiency

Microsoft has launched two custom-designed computing chips, Maia and Cobalt, aimed at internalising AI technologies to manage the high costs of delivering AI services. The Maia chip, developed in collaboration with OpenAI, focuses on accelerating



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AI computing tasks, while the Cobalt chip, a central processing unit, serves as a cost-saving measure and a competitive response to Amazon Web Services' Graviton chips. Maia accelerates AI computing tasks and supports the $30-a-month Copilot service. In 2024, Microsoft will provide Azure services running on the latest chips from Nvidia and Advanced Micro Devices.

Foxconn, Nvidia partner to set up AI data factories

Foxconn is partnering with Nvidia to establish AI data factories, specifically focusing on creating a comprehensive AI system for autonomous electric vehicles. The envisioned AI factory is expected to exist in every sector, contributing to various applications, with a primary objective to create a comprehensive AI system for autonomous electric vehicles. The AI factory will be responsible for developing software for these vehicles. Continuous feedback loop: Data gathered by AI vehicles will be sent back to the factory for software refinement and updates.

STMicroelectronics reports increased net revenues driven by automotive sector

STMicroelectronics reported its financial results for the third quarter of 2023, indicating increased net revenues and stable gross margins driven by growth in the automotive sector. Net revenue for the third quarter jumped by 2.5% year-on-year to $4.43 billion, with a gross margin of 47.6% and an operating

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margin of 28.0%, beating market expectations of $4.38 billion. Net profit for the same period rose to $1.09 billion, translating to earnings of $1.16 per share. By product group, Automotive and Discrete Group (ADG) saw revenue increase by 29.6% compared to the same quarter in the previous year.

Qualcomm, Google collaborate to develop RISC-V wearables

Qualcomm is extending its partnership with Google to develop RISC-V-based wearables to leverage the open source architecture for custom processors in Android ecosystem products. The wearables will run on Google's Wear OS, an Android operating system designed for smartwatches and wearables. Qualcomm aims to launch RISC-V-based wearables globally, including in the United States, providing low power consumption and high performance.

Synopsys, Microsoft partner to adapt Copilot for chip design

Synopsys and Microsoft have collaborated to utilise the Azure OpenAI system for adapting Microsoft's 'Copilot' for chip design, aiming to enhance precision, reduce errors, and streamline the chip design process, by leveraging advanced AI technologies. Microsoft's Copilot is being integrated into its own chip design teams, including the development of the company's first internally developed data centre chips.

Vietnam plans to set up first domestic chip plant

Vietnam is actively pursuing the establishment of its first semiconductor plant despite concerns from US officials about the high costs involved. The government aims to boost semiconductor investments, engaging in negotiations with various companies and expressing its intention to have the nation's premier chip fabrication plant by the end of the decade.